



Facebook IPO to raise \$13.6bn

Facebook set its IPO pricing details; the company is aiming to price its shares between \$28 and \$35, valuing the company at roughly \$88bn <http://dgit.in/JXVnQI>

Cure all tumors

New research has pointed out that a new drug called CD47 could cure all types of cancer <http://dgit.in/JJHH6p>

STORAGE JUST GOT WINGS!

We identify the cloud storage service that makes most sense for you

Vishal Mathur

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

The very fact that cloud storage has been around for so long, without any major horror stories about data disappearing, makes the shift to the cloud easier. Any apprehensions have shifted to the background, also helped by the fact that big names like Microsoft and Google are in the fray.

Do you need it?

Yes. It's available for free, so why not take your share? Google Drive offers 5 GB, Windows SkyDrive offers 7 GB (25 GB for existing users) and Dropbox lets you use 2 GB for free – sizes that can be increased by certain recommended methods. You should definitely store data on the cloud, simply because with smartphone apps, it's easier to access, update, sync and manage on the move. Then again, you don't need to make an entire shift – use the cloud as an extended storage space to whatever setup you already have.

With three of the biggest players lined up, we try to identify which one makes more sense for you.

Your choices...

The cloud storage battles have clearly begun. Microsoft has fired a salvo by making SkyDrive more accessible with fresh additions to the desktop and smartphone app range. The Redmond giant has had this cloud storage service active for quite a few years now, but didn't really bother much about it till



SkyDrive on a mobile device

just recently. New smartphone apps for various platforms and a rejigged space structure show that Microsoft is serious about it.

Let's not forget Dropbox, which has been around for quite a while now, being the simplest service to use. From what we've seen among our social circle, it seems to be the most popular as well. Getting extra space by referring friends probably has something to do with that!

Google responded, as expected, with the Drive. The fact that the world and their dog has a Gmail account will inevitably make it get a huge user demographic signing up rather quickly. Integration with the much-loved Google Docs just adds the cherry to the top of the cake, doesn't it?



The Google Drive UI is the same as Docs'

The question really is – do any of these services offer something that will make you shift from whatever cloud service you're using right now?

Storage and price

Google Drive gets you 5GB file storage space, a bump up to 10 GB for Gmail and a separate 1 GB for Picasa. If you look closely, Google Drive is clearly an extension of Google Docs, with more space. As a package, Gmail and Picasa album storage get a boost as well. Very smartly done, but in one avatar or the other, all of these services already existed!

Microsoft is offering 7GB free space for new and some existing users, but is allowing most existing users to retain the 25GB space quota for free, if accepted within the offer period.

Dropbox starts with 2GB space for free users, with an extra 512MB for every person who accepts your referral and installs the desktop app. Google has a better overall package, irrespective of the fact that it's "old wine in a new bottle". But no annual storage upgrades are available – only monthly price